



Chrome 11 beta out

Chrome 11 Beta is out and apart from sporting a new logo, it has support for speech-to-text with HTML5 speech input API

Toolbox

M11x R3 specs leaked

Alienware's M11x is expected to sport Sandy Bridge processors such as Core i5-2537M, Core i7-2617M and Core i7-2657M

HDD S.M.A.R.T Error, Confused between RAMs, Phone slowing down

Digit Q&A answers these queries and more

Corrupted Media files

I use Tune Up utilities to restore deleted files. Sometimes the media files which are in good condition work properly when I restore them. But sometimes the player tells me that the files are corrupted or damaged. What software can I use to repair these files.

Nithin

Thanks for writing in. It's pretty unusual to use Tune Up Utilities to restore deleted files. You could try using another software such as Recuva (www.piriform.com/recuva) for recovering those files. It may work better than Tune Up utilities.

If the files in question are video files, a free software called DivFix++ (<http://www.divfix.org/>) should be able to help. Try using different players such as VLC, KMPlayer and Media Player Classic too.

HDD S.M.A.R.T error

I am currently facing this strange problem all of a sudden. I have a Seagate 320 GB HDD with loads of data on it. Yesterday, it started to display the following error during startup:

"SATA 1 HDD: S.M.A.R.T Bad, Backup & Replace."

I immediately powered it off. But when I connected this HDD as a slave with another XP containing HDD, it took a long time to boot and all the drives in the faulty HDD were displayed as RAW.

My PC configuration is as follows :

Processor: AMD Phenom X4

Motherboard: ASUS M2N68

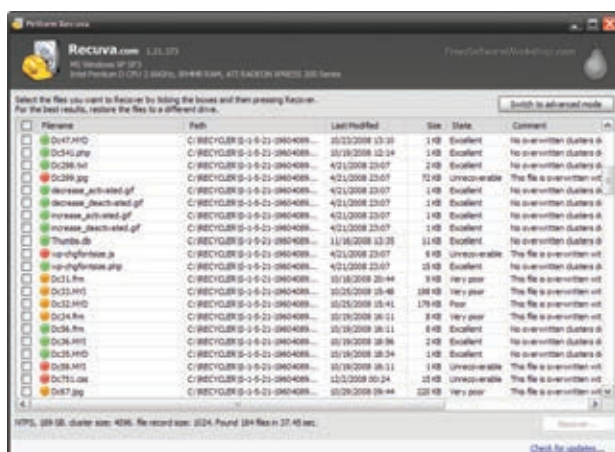
RAM: 2 GB DDR2

HDD: 320 GB Seagate HDD (faulty),

160 GB Seagate HDD (XP installed)

Harpreet Singh

The S.M.A.R.T Bad error indicates that the HDD has gone bad or is going to go bad soon. It may be due to a mechanical hard drive failure which is caused due to motor failures or



Recuva file recovery software

physical damage due to overwriting. After getting this error, you need to take a backup of your critical data, as it is a clear indication that the HDD will die out soon. Considering your faulty HDD is showing up as RAW when you connect it as a slave, you will need to do data recovery. You can use a Live Linux CD to access the data in the faulty drive and copy it over to the working drive or you can use softwares like Test Disk (<http://www.cgsecurity.org/wiki/TestDisk>) which can recover lost partition.

Cabinet ports faulty

I'm a frequent reader of your magazine. I wanted to ask you regarding a problem I am facing. My front USB ports don't work sometimes or they do, but have a very

slow speed. My back USB ports are much better, but their speed is not good when compared to a friend's computer using the same hardware. Aux-in jack in front panel doesn't work properly. What should I do? Should I change my cabinet or motherboard?

Naman

You don't need to change either, just yet. Get a new front-panel connector, and see if that works better.

Make sure the connections from your front panel are fixed properly on to the motherboard.

If your back panel connectors are "slow", we can't really pinpoint a reason for that unless you give us your motherboard model number, CPU, RAM and HDD specs. How fast or slow the PC is when reading from USB depends on a few things: do you have USB 1.1 or 2.0 ports, is your CPU slower than your friend's PC, do you have less RAM, or perhaps the HDD you're copying data to might be slow.

It also could be an early warning of failing hardware, but that's less likely.

Retaining GRUB

I am running Windows 7 and Linux Mint on my PC. My problem is that now I want to format the drive containing Windows 7, but I don't want to lose Mint. Formatting Windows 7 will delete the GRUB and I will not be able to use Mint. Please help me.

Himanshu Namdeo

After formatting, do you intend to reinstall Windows? If you do, then do the following:

Format the Windows drive and reinstall Windows.

Download EasyBCD, and use it to add a boot entry for your OS.